the day, people would have crowded at shops and markets to stock up on items, leading to panic buying and risking rampant community spread of the contagion.

The prime minister started his address by acknowledging the efforts of the people who followed junta curfew and for making it a success. He then went ahead to talk about how experiences of other countries within the grip of the virus have taught us that social distancing is the only way to break the chain of the infection. He explained further,

> You are also witnessing how this pandemic has rendered even the most developed countries of the world helpless. It is not that these countries are not putting in adequate efforts, or that they lack resources. The fact is that the Coronavirus is spreading so rapidly that despite all preparations and efforts, countries are finding it hard to cope with the situation.[2]

He clarified that social distancing wouldn't just mean staying away from sick people, it would mean staying away from each other. He further added that:

> Keeping in mind health sector experts and experiences of other countries, the nation is about to take a very important decision today. From 12 midnight today the entire country, please listen carefully, the entire country shall go under complete lockdown. In order to protect the country, and each of its citizens, from midnight tonight, a complete ban is being imposed on people from stepping out of their homes. Every state of the country, every Union Territory, every district, every municipality, every village, every street, every locality is being put under lockdown. This is in effect a type of curfew only. A few levels more than Janata-Curfew, it is more stringent. This is a critical step in the decisive fight against the Corona Pandemic. There is no doubt the nation will have to pay an economic cost for this lockdown. However, at this moment, my utmost priority, and that of the Government of India, state and local governments is to protect the life of every Indian. Hence, it is my plea and prayer to you to continue to remain wherever you are right now in the country.